ONE-PAGE PREACHING OUTLINE

The Man Who Pulled Down the House

Samson · Judges 16:4–31

Primary text: Judges 16:4–31 **Also read:** Judges 13–15 · Hebrews 11:32 · John 2:18–22 · 2 Corinthians 12:9–10 **Big idea:** Samson pulled down Dagon's house with his own hands and died in the rubble; Jesus let his own house be pulled down and rose from it. **Time:** 55–60 minutes, including a 3–5 minute response (6,874 words at about 120 wpm). **Aim:** From admiring strength to trusting the source; from hiding to crying out to the God who remembers.

MOVEMENT MAP

MIN	SECTION	BEATS AND TRANSITION
5	**Introduction: The strongest man in the room**	The children's Bible hero vs. the tragedy: betrayal, blindness, a crowded temple, a grave. Our culture worships strength; the church is not immune. State the big idea. → *"Let us read the story."*
7	**The gift and the secret**	Judges 13: the angel, the barren woman, the Nazirite from the womb, "he shall begin to save Israel." The Spirit is the source; the hair is the sign. Delilah, the five lords, 5,500 pieces of silver. Three lies. "All his heart." → *"The secret was never a what. It was a Who."*
8	**The night he did not know**	The shave, the sleep, "The Philistines are upon you." "I will go out as at other times." "He did not know that the LORD had left him." Empowerment withdrawn, not salvation lost. Blinded, shackled, grinding. The hair grows. → *"Long before they took his eyes, he had stopped seeing."*
8	**The prayer in the dark**	Dagon's temple. "Our god has given Samson into our hand." The blind judge between the pillars; 3,000 on the roof. "O Lord GOD, remember me." Covenant faith and revenge. God answers. The house falls. Tragedy, not template. Care for the suicidal. → *"He has a prayer. And a prayer is enough."*
8	**The burial and the record**	Family tomb between Zorah and Eshtaol. "He had judged Israel twenty years." Judges 21:25; Samson as Israel in one body. Hebrews 11:32: grace, not approval. → *"There is a temple coming."*
8	**The temple that rose**	John 2:19–22: "Destroy this temple." Samson pulled the house down; Jesus let his body be pulled down and rose. 2 Corinthians 12:9. Two people: the strong and the broken. → *"Samson is what we are. Jesus is what we need."*
7	**Application: What do you do with the strength?**	Name the gift. Do not confuse the sign with the source. Tell the truth about your eyes. Pray the small prayer. → *"Get up and walk in the light you have."*
3	**The invitation**	The strong one and the broken one. "Remember me" is enough. → *"Come out of the dark."*
5	**Response and closing**	Silence. Name the sign, the eyes, the secret. Pray "Remember me." Care note. Prayer. The family tomb and the empty tomb. → *"The voice is not asking you to be stronger. It is asking you to come."*

Total: 57 minutes with a full response; 55–60 with normal variation.

LINES TO LAND

- "The hair was the sign. The Spirit was the source."
- "He did not know that the LORD had left him."
- "The strongest man in the world was not strong enough to leave the room."
- "Samson pulled down the house and died in the rubble. Jesus let the house be pulled down and rose from it."

GUARDRAILS

- Do not celebrate Samson's final act. It is suicide-adjacent revenge; preach tragedy and grace, never a template. Include crisis care.
- Do not make Delilah the sole villain. She is named, not labeled a prostitute; her motives are money and allegiance. Samson's choices are the focus.
- Keep the text honest: hair is the sign, the Spirit the source; 16:13–14 is longer in the Masoretic Text; the Gaza temple is unidentified.
- Do not preach 16:20 as loss of salvation. It is the withdrawal of the Spirit's empowerment for Samson's calling.
- Do not turn Samson into a simple Christ figure; the connection is contrast, not allegory.
- The gospel must be explicit: John 2:19–22 and 2 Corinthians 12:9. Do not end on "be strong."

IF YOU MUST CUT

- **To 50 minutes:** Introduction to 4, Movement 1 to 6, Movement 2 to 6, Movement 4 to 6, Application to 6. Keep the sign/source, "he did not know," the prayer, and the risen temple.
- **Never cut:** "He did not know…," "Remember me," the falling house, Hebrews 11:32, John 2:19–22.